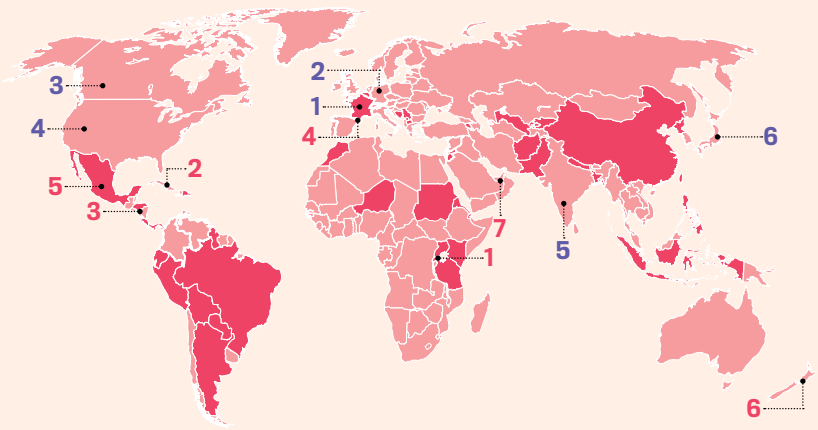
THE GLOBAL PERSPECTIVE



COUNTRIES WITH RESERVATION FOR WOMEN

These countries have some form of reservation for women in their national parliaments

France, China, North Korea, Brazil, Argentina, Taiwan, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Indonesia, Kyrgyzstan, Uzbekistan, Niger, Ecuador, Bolivia, Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, Guyana, Honduras, Mexico, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Belgium, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Macedonia, Serbia & Montenegro, Djibouti, Eritrea, Jordan, Kenya, Morocco, Rwanda, Sudan, Tanzania, Uganda, Afghanistan, Armenia, the Philippines

COUNTRIES WITH HIGHEST WOMEN REPRESENTATION

Women account for half the legislators in national parliaments of these seven nations. In another 23 countries, women's share in parliament has reached or surpassed 40 per cent

COUNTRY	LOWER OR SINGLE HOUSE	UPPER HOUSE
1. Rwanda	**61.3%**	**34.6%**
2. Cuba*	**55.7%**	
3. Nicaragua	**51.7%**	
4. Andorra*	**50%**	
5. Mexico	**50%**	
6. New Zealand*	**50%**	**50.4%**
7. UAE	**50%**	

HOW TOP DEMOCRACIES FARE IN COMPARISON

COUNTRY (GLOBAL RANK)	LOWER OR SINGLE HOUSE	UPPER HOUSE
1. France *(34)*	**37.8%**	**35.1%**
2. Germany* *(44)*	**35.1%**	**40.6%**
3. Canada* *(61)*	**30.7%**	**53.9%**
4. USA* *(70)*	**28.8%**	**25%**
5. India *(141)*	**15.2%**	**13.9%**
6. Japan* *(164)*	**10.3%**	**25.8%**

*Countries with no reservation for women

warns Yogendra Yadav, political activist and founder of Swaraj India.

On their part, Opposition parties have dismissed the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam as nothing more than a political '*jumla*' and an electorally-motivated move with no fixed timeline for implementation. They are accusing the government of "fooling the people" and not bringing in reservation right away but introducing the bill solely with an eye on the 2024 Lok Sabha polls. Political scientists reach a similar conclusion. "The government is not serious about women's reservation; if it was, it could have got it passed in 2019 itself, given that it has a majority in the Lok Sabha," says Zoya Hasan, professor emerita, Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), Delhi. "It is no rocket science to see that the women's reservation bill has been introduced six months before the parliamentary election with an eye on electoral gain and keeping the issue alive without actually implementing reservations."

141

INDIA'S RANK

Among 185 countries in terms of share of women in national parliament, with 15 per cent female members in Lok Sabha and 14 per cent in Rajya Sabha

26.5

PER CENT

Women parliamentarians in single/ lower houses globally, up from 11 per cent in 1995; in 1990, the UN endorsed a target of 30 per cent women in decision-making positions

THE BJP LOGIC

BJP insiders, however, insist that there is a positive practical logic to what others see as tokenism. The next delimitation will not only restructure but increase the number of constituencies, but since it is just three years away, there is no point in implementing it for the 2024 election. Enacting it, though, will push all political parties, including the BJP, to groom prospective women candidates for future elections. Others corroborate this by saying that an immediate rollout of reservations would have led to internal rebellion, with many stalwarts fearing losing their seats. "The reason is that a large number of men who have been nurturing their seats for a long time may end up losing them," says P.D.T. Achary, secretary-general of the 14th and 15th Lok Sabhas and constitutional expert. "They will not accept this change being made abruptly, leaving them high and dry. Every political party is going to face this problem." For Prof. Lekha Chakraborty of the National